the hardest part of all (we're only built to fall)

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/50010913.

Rating:
Explicit

Archive Warning:
Creator Chose Not To Use Archive Warnings

Category:
F/F

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationship:
Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Bow/Glimmer (She-Ra)

Character:
Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra), Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner (She-Ra), Scorpia (She-Ra), Perfuma (She-Ra), Mermista (She-Ra), Sea Hawk (She-Ra), Frosta (She-Ra), Hordak (She-Ra), She-Ra (She-Ra)

Additional Tags:
Minor Bow/Glimmer (She-Ra), Lesbian Catra (She-Ra), Lesbian Adora (She-Ra), she-ra au, so much tension, Angst with a Happy Ending, Slow Burn, Eventual Smut, Eventual Fluff, catra joins the rebellion (kinda)

Language:
English

Stats:
Published: 2023-09-11 Words: 1,162 Chapters: 1/1

the hardest part of all (we’re only built to fall)
Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/50010913.

Rating:
Explicit

Archive Warning:
Creator Chose Not To Use Archive Warnings

Category:
F/F

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationship:
Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Bow/Glimmer (She-Ra)

Character:
Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra), Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner (She-Ra), Scorpia (She-Ra), Perfuma (She-Ra), Mermista (She-Ra), Sea Hawk (She-Ra), Frosta (She-Ra), Hordak (She-Ra), She-Ra (She-Ra)

Additional Tags:
Minor Bow/Glimmer (She-Ra), Lesbian Catra (She-Ra), Lesbian Adora (She-Ra), she-ra au, so much tension, Angst with a Happy Ending, Slow Burn, Eventual Smut, Eventual Fluff, catra joins the rebellion (kinda)

Language:
English

Stats:
Published: 2023-09-11 Words: 1,162 Chapters: 1/1

the hardest part of all (we’re only built to fall)

by gdawglovesu

Summary

at the end of season 3, catra chooses to go with the princesses back to brightmoon. adora is absolutely furious with catra for activating the portal, and catra needs to prove herself worthy of the princesses trust again. but what happens when she starts getting closer than expected with the most prestigious princess of them all?

AU where catra joins the rebellion instead of running off with hordak at the end of s3. i really wanted to make catra a good guy sooner than s5 😭

Notes

hi! this is my first serious attempt at writing a story, so if the writing gets iffy at some points, that’s why. feel free to comment any thoughts u have! this story will most likely be 5 chaps long!

See the end of the work for more notes

Flashes of light ebb throughout the room.

A deafening noise rips throughout time, tearing the world to shreds.

It seems shrill, silent. But it pounds through the ground and splits it open, blinding rays of pure white light escaping from the cracks of a world which was once deemed the most magical planet in the entire universe.

Catra lurches forward with a gasp. She opens her eyes and takes in the pastel color palette of the walls surrounding her. Her attention is drawn towards the window, watching as the leaves atop the giant trees sway back and forth. A sigh of relief slips from her lips.

The memories of the past few days began to form back into her mind. She remembers it all clearly now.

She-Ra emerged from the portal, glowing with the same vibrant light she always did. Catra watched in awe as she stepped from the blinding circle, the way the muscles in her legs flexed with every movement, her stone cold face, vivid blue eyes piercing Catra’s own.

Catra would never admit it, but Adora had captured her heart right then and there.

She-Ra's guttural yell blares throughout Hordak's sanctum as she swings the sword rapidly behind her, destroying the portal with one strike. Catra is frozen, awestruck by how Adora could have possibly emerged from that portal unscathed. Her princess friends crowd her, showering her with praise.

"Touching as this is, we need to go!" Catra turns her head towards Shadow Weaver's voice, along with the Rebellion members. To Catra's dismay, Adora would never forget about her.

What a terrible promise they've made to each other.

She watches as She-Ra's eyebrows furrow with pure rage. Catra takes a deep breath, and braces for the impact that will, hopefully, end everything.

She has nothing left to live for anyways.

With the big plan that she and Hordak had been building up for weeks crushed under the heel of She-Ra, Catra had lost.

She lost to Adora.

She lost to the Rebellion, the princesses Adora and her had sworn to destroy. She had lost to the planet, the one that Adora had promised her they would rule together.

She had lost everything.

Catra's eyes close on their own. Her body relaxes, her muscles stop tensing, as she had stopped caring about what would happen next. She was ready.

A few moments pass. Catra realizes that she is still alive, that She-Ra hasn't struck her sword through her and ended their rivalry once and for all.

She's incredibly confused when she opens her eyes.

Every single princess (and Bow, of course) had their eyes on her. Adora stood in front of her, still in the form of She-Ra, looming above her.

She was reaching her hand out to her.

Catra looked at her, tilting her head in confusion. Adora looks into her eyes, her expression unchanging.

"Come with us, Catra." she finally says.

Catra ponders the possibilities of choosing this outcome. She would be safe from the Horde, more so Hordak, who probably wants her dead more than anyone else in the universe right now. She would be under the princess's supervision, which would be ten times better than rotting in a Horde cell.

She then thinks about the other possibility, rejecting Adora.

She only thinks about it for a second before her heart throbs with a terrible ache.

Option one it is.

Catra slips her hand into Adora's own. Her expression immediately lights with shock, her mouth slightly parted in a gasp, her eyes widened.

"I don't have any other choice. This is not because I like you." She scoffs.

Adora's face shifts into that god awful smile, the smile that rendered Catra useless every single time.

"Sure, Force Capitan." She laughs.

Catra can’t believe she did that.

Now she’s being kept in Brightmoon’s prison cell, the spare room. At least its a nice cell. She crawls out of the obscenely fluffy bed and begins to examine the room around her. It was very open, lots of royally designed archways in place of windows. Of course, Queen Glimmer had placed forcefields in the archways that prevented Catra from stepping outside. No possible way out was left untouched.

Typical princesses. Always such overachievers. Catra laughed to herself.

Although, truly, none of this is funny. Catra is imprisoned in the kingdom she hates the most in the entire galaxy, and now has no choice but to deal with the most annoying person she has ever known.

BANG!

She turns around to see what could’ve caused such a noise. As if on queue, Adora, in the form of She-Ra, barges through her cell door (its still just the spare room.)

“Was it really necessary to make all that noise? You’re disturbing my daily meditation.” Catra jeers, looking at Adora.

She’s absolutely furious. Her skirt is flowing in the non-existent wind, along with her hair, as she steps towards Catra. She can’t help but be terrified. How do all of Adora’s princess friends handle this?

“Shut up, Catra.” Adora’s almost growling, like a feral beast hunting down its prey. Her hand, *my god her hands are massive,* darts out to grab the collar of Catra’s shirt, yanking her off of the floor in a split second. Catra barely has time to breathe before she’s basically being choked out.

“Hordak has already begun attacking Rebel villages left and right.” Adora is inches away from her face, her breathing labored and heavy. She loosens her grip on Catra’s shirt, allowing her to speak.

“You’re exhausted, Adora,” Catra feels sorry for the poor princess. Running around as an 8-foot goddess of a women. She couldn’t even begin to imagine the hardships she faced.

“You have to know something. What is he planning?” Adora snarls angrily. *Wow, she really is riled up.*

“You’re tense. Maybe you should put me down and we can talk this out like friends!” Catra smiles, and Adora just seems to get angrier.

“We’re *not* friends, Catra. You ruined that.” She relaxed her hand, letting Catra fall to the floor with a thud.

Catra winced at her coldness. She had to admit, Adora's words cut much deeper than her sword ever could. But as she looks up at her, Catra sees that She-Ra has disappeared, and Adora has replaced her.

She didn't mind. She always liked Adora better anyways.

"Jeez, you could've at least dropped me from a little closer to the ground instead of 12 feet above it," Catra sputtered out, gripping at the ankle she landed on. Adora crouched down and looked into Catra's eyes.

She thought she saw a sparkle of remorse. Maybe even pity.

Adora stood up almost as quickly as Catra looked back at her, and turned away.

"You'll be fine. You've been in worse shape." Without looking back, Adora walked out of the room, closing the door behind her. Catra could only stare at the door, waiting for Adora to come back.

She didn't move all night.

End Notes

wanted to write more but next chapter will do just fine ;)

Please drop by the archive and comment to let the author know if you enjoyed their work!